Directions for the following 7 (seven) items :

Read the following four passages and answer the items that follow. Your answers to these items should be based on the passages only.

Passage-7

India has suffered from persistent high inflation. Increase in administered prices, demand and supply imbalances, imported inflation aggravated by rupee depreciation, and speculation─have combined to keep high inflation going. If there is an element common to all of them, it is that many of them are the outcomes of economic reforms. India's vulnerability to the effects of changes in international prices has increased with trade liberalisation. The effort to reduce subsidies has resulted in a continuous increase in the prices of commodities that are administered.

8. What is the *most logical, rational and crucial message* that is implied in the above passage?

(a) Under the present circumstances, India should completely avoid all trade liberalisation policies and all subsidies.

(b) Due to its peculiar socio-economic situation, India is not yet ready for trade liberalisation process.

(c) There is no solution in sight for the problems of continuing poverty and inflation in India in the near future.

(d) Economic reforms can often create a high inflation economy.

Ans. (d) : It is clearly mentioned in the passage that India has been suffering from persistent high inflation due to liberalization of trade and increase in economic reforms. Hence, option (d) is the correct answer.

Passage-8

No Right is absolute, exclusive or inviolable. The Right of personal property, similarly, has to be perceived in the larger context of its assumed legitimacy. The Right of personal property should unite the principle of liberty with that of equality, and both with the principle of cooperation.

9. In the light of the argument in the above passage, which one of the following statements is the *most convincing explanation*?

(a) The Right of personal property is a Natural Right duly supported by statutes and scriptures.

(b) Personal property is a theft and an instrument of exploitation. The Right of personal property is therefore violative of economic justice.

(c) The Right of personal property is violative of distributive justice and negates the principle of cooperation.

(d) The comprehensive idea of economic justice demands that the Right of each person to acquisition of property has to be reconciled with that of others.

Ans. (d) : The most credible explanation in the light of the arguments given in the above passage is that the broad idea of economic justice demands that the right of every individual to acquire property should be harmonized with the right to acquire property of others.

Passage-9

The conflict between man and State is as old as State history. Although attempts have been made for centuries to bring about a proper adjustment between the competing claims of State and the individual, the solution seems to be still far off. This is primarily because of the dynamic nature of human society where old values and ideas constantly yield place to new ones. It is obvious that if individuals are allowed to have absolute freedom of speech and action, the result would be chaos, ruin and anarchy.

10. The author's viewpoint can be *best summed* up in which of the following statements?

(a) The conflict between the claims of State and individual remains unresolved.

(b) Anarchy and chaos are the obvious results of democratic traditions.

(c) Old values, ideas and traditions persist despite the dynamic nature of human society.

(d) Constitutional guarantee of freedom of speech is not in the interest of society.

Ans. (a) : It is clearly said in the passage that, "The struggle between man and the state is as old as the history of the state". Although there have been attempts over the centuries to reconcile the competing claims of the state and the individual, the solution still seems to be faraway on the basis, option (d) presents the best summary of the authors point of view.

Passage-10

Climate change is a complex policy issue with major implications in terms of finance. All actions to address climate change ultimately involve costs. Funding is vital for countries like India to design and implement adaptation and mitigation plans and projects. Lack of funding is a large impediment to implementing adaptation plans. The scale and magnitude of the financial support required by developing countries to enhance their domestic mitigation and adaptation actions are a matter of intense debate in the multilateral negotiations under the United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change (UNFCCC). The Convention squarely puts the responsibility for provision of financial support on the developed countries, taking into account their contribution to the stock of greenhouse gases (GHGs) in the atmosphere. Given the magnitude of the task and the funds required, domestic finances are likely to fall short of the current and projected needs of the developing countries. Global funding through the multilateral mechanism of the Convention will enhance their domestic capacity to finance the mitigation efforts.

11. According to the passage, which of the following is/are a matter of intense debate in the multilateral negotiations under UNFCCC regarding the role of developing countries in climate change?

1. The scale and size of required financial support.
2. The crop loss due to climate change in the developing countries.
3. To enhance the mitigation and adaptation actions in the developing countries.

Select the correct answer using the code given below :

(a) 1 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans. (c) : From reading the passage, it is known that, the scale and magnitude of financial assistance required by developing countries for the promotion of their domestic mitigation and adaptation actions in climate change is a matter of intense or serious discussion. The role of developing countries should enhance the mitigation and adoption actions under UNFCCC. Hence, option (c) will be the correct answer.

12. In this passage, the Convention puts the responsibility for the Provision of financial support on the developed countries because of

1. their higher level of per capita incomes.
2. their large quantum of GDP.
3. their large contribution to the stock of GHGs in the atmosphere.

Select the correct answer using the code given below :

(a) 1 only (b) 1 and 2 only
(c) 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans. (c) : The passage clearly states that, The UNFCCC convention places an equal responsibility on the developed countries to provide financial assistance, based on their contribution to the accumulation of greenhouse gases in the atmosphere. Hence option (c) would be the correct answer.

13. With regards to developing countries, it can be inferred from the passage that climate change is likely to have implications on their

1. domestic finances.
2. capacity for multilateral trade.

Select the correct answer using the code given below :

(a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans. (a) : With respect to developing countries, it can be inferred from the passage that climate change is likely to impact their domestic finances.

14. Which one of the following is essentially discussed in this passage?

(a) Conflict between developed and developing countries regarding support for mitigation

(b) Occurrence of climate change due to excessive exploitation of natural resources by the developed countries

(c) Lack of political will on the part of all the countries to implement adaptation plans

(d) Governance problems of developing countries as a result of climate change

Ans. (a) : This passage essentially discusses the conflict between developed and developing countries about providing aid for mitigation.

Directions for the following 8 (eight) items :

Read the following *seven passages* and answer the items that follow. Your answers to these items should be based on the passages only.

Passage-11

The richer States have a responsibility to cut down carbon emissions and promote clean energy investments. These are the States that got electricity, grew faster and now have high per capita income, making them capable of sharing India's burden of becoming eco-friendly. Delhi, for example, can help by generating its own clean electricity using solar rooftop panels or even help poor States finance their clean energy projects. It is no secret that State Electricity Boards, which control 95% of the distribution network, are neck-deep in losses. These losses further discourage State utilities from adopting renewable energy as it is more expensive than fossil fuels.

15. Which among the following is the *most logical and rational assumption* that can be made from the above passage?

(a) The richer States must lead in the production and adoption of renewable energy.

(b) The poor States always have to depend on rich States for electricity.

(c) The State Electricity Boards can improve their finances by undertaking clean energy projects.

(d) The high economic disparity between the rich and poor States is the major cause of high carbon emissions in India.

Ans. (a) : It is stated at the very beginning of the passage that relatively prosperous states should take the lead in producing and adopting renewable energy.

Passage-12

Set against a rural backdrop, `Stench of kerosene' is the story of a couple, Guleri and Manak, who have been happily married for several years but do not have a child. Manak's mother is desperate to have a grandchild to carry on the family name. Hence, she gets Manak remarried in Guleri's absence. Manak, who acts as a reluctant but passive spectator, is meanwhile, informed by a friend that Guleri, on hearing about her husband's second marriage, poured kerosene on her clothes and set fire to them. Manak is heartbroken and begins to live as if he were a dead man. When his second wife delivers a son, Manak stares at the child for a long time and blurts out, ``Take him away! He stinks of kerosene."